ClaimProof — Distributor Interview

15 min · research, not a pitch

Company / revenue: | Name / role: | Date: | Product category:

Rules: Ask about the **past**, not hypotheticals, until Q6. Don't describe the product before Q6. Write down the **numbers they actually say** ("about 40 a month", "$180k last year"), not your impression. Silence is fine; let them fill it. Target roles: controller/CFO, AR manager, customer service manager.

1 How many damage or shortage credits did you issue last year, and roughly what total value?

Probe: Is that tracked, or a guess? Biggest single claim? What share of revenue?

TESTS: UNVERIFIED CREDITS ARE A MEANINGFUL DOLLAR AMOUNT

2 How do claims arrive, and who approves them?

Probe: Email, phone, portal, rep? Who issues the credit, and is there a dollar limit before sign-off?

TESTS: SOMEONE OWNS THE PROBLEM

3 What evidence do you require? What happens when it's missing?

Probe: Do you match photos to the shipment (BOL, POD, label)? Do you ever credit with no photo at all?

4 Have you caught a fake or recycled photo, or suspected one?

Probe: Tell me about the last time. How did you notice? What did you do with that account?

5 Are some accounts claiming far more than others? What do you do about it?

Probe: Do you know their claim rate vs. other accounts? Has it cost you a customer relationship?

TESTS: BUDGET AND APPETITE TO ACT

6 *(Last) If every claim came through a link that verified photos and matched them to the shipment, would your customers use it? Would you require it above a certain dollar amount?*

Probe: What threshold? Which customers would push back? Who would sign off on paying for it?

TESTS: CUSTOMERS WILL ACCEPT A CAPTURE LINK (LIKELY DEAL-BREAKER)

NUMBERS THEY SAID

Claims / year	
Total credits $ / year	
Share issued without verifying	
Link threshold ($)	

VERDICT

- **Kill** if credits are small, or they'd never ask customers to use a link.
- **Promising** if credits are material, approval is loose, and they'd require the link above a threshold.
- Ask for one intro to a peer distributor.

Circle: Kill · Unclear · Promising

Outreach: "Hi [Name], I'm researching how distributors verify damage claims. Could I ask you a few questions for 15 minutes? Not selling anything; happy to share what I learn from the other conversations."